MONSTER HITMAKER

How **Dinesh Vijan** made Maddock Films a juggernaut of Hindi cinema through a fearless, content-first approach

By **SUHANI SINGH**

On

APRIL 7, AS LEADING ACTORS AND FILMMAKERS FROM the Hindi film industry gathered at Taj Land's End in Mumbai to ring in Maddock Films' 20th anniversary bash, one man stood tallest—studio founder Dinesh Vijan. Dressed in a black shirt and trousers, Vijan, or Dino as he is known in industry circles, had good reason to be proud. His last two films, *Stree 2* (2024) and *Chhaava* (2025), had grossed over Rs 1,100 crore in India alone, with *Stree 2* emerging the highest grossing Hindi film ever. Rajkummar Rao, Varun Dhawan, Vicky Kaushal, Kriti Sanon and filmmakers like Sriram Raghavan and Amar Kaushik spoke effusively about the production house. "The guest list became so big that we had to go to Taj; otherwise, I'd have hosted it at our office or some little bar," says Vijan.

A no-frills producer, Vijan may not be a recluse like Aditya Chopra of Yash Raj Films, but he is

"OURS IS A CONTENT-FIRST APPROACH. ANYONE WHO HAS A WHACKED-OUT IDEA COMES TO US FIRST, WHICH IS GOOD. WE LIKE MAKING ARTISTIC FILMS THAT RESONATE WITH AN EMERGING INDIA"

DINESH VIJAN
Founder, Maddock Films



Photo: MADDOCK FILMS